Gmail

ML Financial Group <mike@mlgroup.us>

Introduction

12 messages

Naeem Malik <naeem.malik@scorevolunteer.org> Wed, Mar 18, 2026 at 2:34 PM
To: Dave Weiner <wdavid@berkeley.edu>, ML Financial Group <mike@mlgroup.us>

Hi Michael and Dave:

Michael, it was nice talking to you this morning. As I mentioned, you need proof of concept and validation. As I recommended for you best option will be a program offered by UC, Dave is the director of this program and his information is as follows: Please contact him.

Dave Weiner
Program Director - UC Berkeley NSF I-Corps
NSF I-Corps Hub Northwest | NSF I-Corps Hub Northwest LinkedIn
UC Berkeley Innovation and Entrepreneurship
LinkedIn | Schedule a Call

Hi Dave:

I have a client, Michael Leavenworth , planning to start a company as an entrepreneur.
I suggested he talk to you and get your help and if possible enroll in your program.
• Client Name: Michael Leavenworth
• Phone: 7727130935
• Email: mike@mlgroup.us
I am forwarding this email to you for your reference.

Best Regards
Malik

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Naeem Malik (Malik)
Business Counselor / Industry Analysts / Industry Mentor
San Francisco / East Bay SCORE
5627 Telegraph Ste. 133
Oakland Ca 93609
Office Number: (510)273-6611
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SCORE East Bay Serving Alameda, Contra Costa & Solano Counties

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ML Financial Group <mike@mlgroup.us> Wed, Mar 18, 2026 at 2:46 PM
To: Naeem Malik <naeem.malik@scorevolunteer.org>, Dave Weiner <wdavid@berkeley.edu>

I very much appreciate this warm introduction, thank you, Malik. It was a great pleasure to learn from your advice and receive your guidance this afternoon (EST), I will accept it and provide it the care it requires.

Good morning Dave,

I am extremely interested in learning more about this path and I am committed to doing everything it takes to succeed in this journey.

When timing permits, I would like an opportunity to meet you so you can determine if my cofounder Owen Peterson, and I are a natural fit for your program.

Best,

Mike
ML Financial Group
Mobile: 772-713-0935

[Quoted text hidden]

ML Financial Group <mike@mlgroup.us> Wed, Mar 18, 2026 at 2:56 PM
To: Owen Peterson <ocpeterson@yahoo.com>

email thread

Best,

Mike
ML Financial Group
Mobile: 772-713-0935

Forwarded Conversation

Subject: Introduction

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From: **ML Financial Group** <mike@mlgroup.us>
Date: Wed, Mar 18, 2026 at 2:46 PM
To: Naeem Malik <naeem.malik@scorevolunteer.org>, Dave Weiner <wdavid@berkeley.edu>
[Quoted text hidden]

Dave Weiner <wdavid@berkeley.edu> Wed, Mar 18, 2026 at 4:31 PM
To: mike@mlgroup.us

Malik - thank you for the introduction! Shifting you to bcc to spare your inbox.

Mike - great to meet you and I'd be happy to connect. I'll email you more info on NSF I-Corps now, as well as my call link if you'd like to discuss further. Look forward to having you involved in NSF I-Corps.

Best,
Dave
[Quoted text hidden]
--
Dave Weiner
Program Director - UC Berkeley NSF I-Corps
NSF I-Corps Hub Northwest | LinkedIn
UC Berkeley Innovation and Entrepreneurship | Schedule a Call

---

Dave Weiner <wdavid@berkeley.edu> Wed, Mar 18, 2026 at 4:33 PM
To: mike@mlgroup.us

Mike,

The announcement email for the upcoming Berkeley NSF I-Corps course is below. We run a course each month, and you need to have a team of at least two teammates to participate. The training will give you a much deeper understanding into all the different stakeholders who influence whether or not your technology is ultimately adopted.

More details on the April course and dates/application link are below, but if you have any questions or would like to discuss more, let's hop on a chat.

All the best,
Dave

Do you have a startup idea? Are you looking for a proven method to validate your idea?

Berkeley NSF I-Corps offers a free remote 10 day course based on Steve Blank's Lean LaunchPad. The three evening sessions teach you to identify your top customer segment and value propositions, and accelerate finding product market fit.

Outside of class, you'll do at least 20 interviews with potential customers as part of the customer discovery process. You can expect to spend 30-35 hours outside of class on interviews.

Eligible teams that complete the course with Hub recommendation might also qualify for the 7 week, 100 customer discovery interview Hub National program with $5,000 in customer discovery funding. Teams that complete the National program have a much higher funding rate, including SBIR grants and investment, and alumni include Inkspace Imaging (SkyDeck/Bakar Fellow), Correlia Biosystems (Y Combinator), Intropic Materials (Activate Fellow), and Amber Bio (a16z).

UC Berkeley is the lead institution of the NSF I-Corps Hub Northwest.

When: Course sessions are held online April 20, 23, & 30 from 5-8pm PST

Who: Any team (2-4 people) with a STEM technology based startup idea

Application deadline: March 27

You'll find the application for the course here. You'll be contacted 2-3 weeks before the first day of class to schedule a team interview with the I-Corps instructor.
[Quoted text hidden]

ML Financial Group <mike@mlgroup.us> Wed, Mar 18, 2026 at 4:38 PM
To: Dave Weiner <wdavid@berkeley.edu>, Owen Peterson <ocpeterson@yahoo.com>
Bcc: "naeem.malik@scorevolunteer.org" <naeem.malik@scorevolunteer.org>

Thank you Dave, including Owen here as well and also bccing Malik to keep him in the loop on my reply. We will complete the application and I will circle back around when that is submitted.

Best,

Michael Leavenworth
ML Financial Group
Mobile: 772-713-0935

[Quoted text hidden]

ML Financial Group <mike@mlgroup.us> Wed, Mar 18, 2026 at 5:37 PM
To: Dave Weiner <wdavid@berkeley.edu>, Owen Peterson <ocpeterson@yahoo.com>
Bcc: "naeem.malik@scorevolunteer.org" <naeem.malik@scorevolunteer.org>

Hi Dave and Malik (BCC),

We just submitted our application.

Best,

Mike
ML Financial Group
Mobile: 772-713-0935

[Quoted text hidden]

Dave Weiner <wdavid@berkeley.edu> Wed, Mar 18, 2026 at 6:49 PM
To: ML Financial Group <mike@mlgroup.us>
Cc: Owen Peterson <ocpeterson@yahoo.com>

Thank you - confirming receipt! We should be back in touch in early April with next steps in the application process.

All the best,
Dave
[Quoted text hidden]

ML Financial Group <mike@mlgroup.us> Wed, Mar 18, 2026 at 8:54 PM
To: Naeem Malik <naeem.malik@scorevolunteer.org>, Owen Peterson <ocpeterson@yahoo.com>

Hi Malik,

Owen and I are moving quickly towards customer discovery, independent of the NSF program. We have a roadmap to prepare for the NSF program, and I am curious to get your input on what to expect, how best to prepare, and specifically, how the program facilitates customer discovery. Additionally, based on your input, we are re-evaluating our target market and will revise our customer discovery plan.

We greatly appreciate your guidance and fast action with the warm introduction to Dave.

Best,

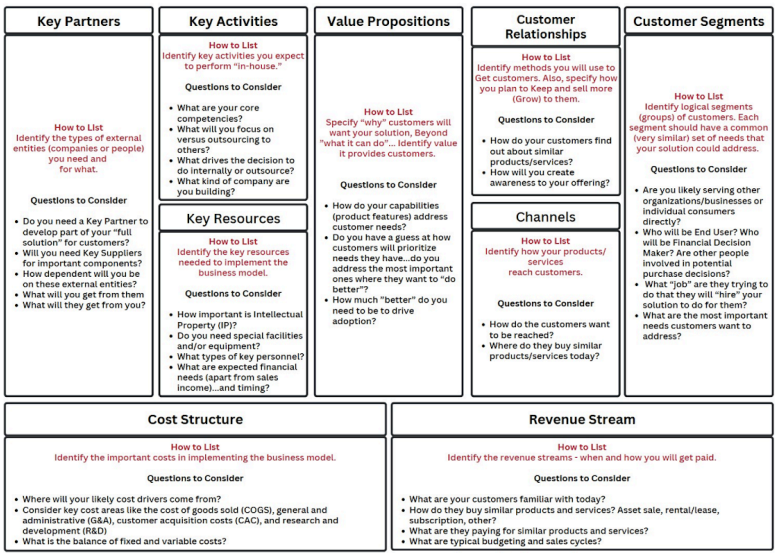
Michael Leavenworth
ML Financial Group
Mobile: 772-713-0935

On Wed, Mar 18, 2026 at 2:34 PM Naeem Malik <naeem.malik@scorevolunteer.org> wrote:
[Quoted text hidden]

Naeem Malik <naeem.malik@scorevolunteer.org> Thu, Mar 19, 2026 at 1:57 AM
To: ML Financial Group <mike@mlgroup.us>
Cc: Owen Peterson <ocpeterson@yahoo.com>

Hi:

That is an excellent idea. To achieve the best result. you have to master it. Things run around the BMC air table.
Complete example is attached with a question to consider. I hope it will help you for customer discovery.



Best Regards

Malik
[Quoted text hidden]

ML Financial Group <mike@mlgroup.us> Thu, Mar 19, 2026 at 4:21 AM
To: Naeem Malik <naeem.malik@scorevolunteer.org>
Cc: Owen Peterson <ocpeterson@yahoo.com>

Hi Malik,

I may have done myself a small disservice by not sharing more of my executive profile with you. In 2015, I was studying an online course in Stanford Design Thinking, and around the same time I completed a "Lean Startup" certification program at Florida Atlantic University, based on the same book by Eric Ries.

Additionally, our development software frameworks and information system design frameworks work like this --> Claude Command Line Interface --> BMAD Github Repository (All Modules).

There is a good chance you are already familiar with this - but if we are on the leading edge, you may not be, their Github repository is here. https://github.com/bmad-code-org/BMAD-METHOD

The relevant part of their modules for this conversation is: Creative Intelligence Suite, which is kind of hidden within BMAD's Module Documentation:

Modules

BMad Method extends with official modules for specialized domains. Available during installation or anytime after.

Module	Purpose
BMad Method (BMM)	Core framework with 34+ workflows
BMad Builder (BMB)	Create custom BMad agents and workflows
Test Architect (TEA)	Risk-based test strategy and automation
Game Dev Studio (BMGD)	Game development workflows (Unity, Unreal, Godot)
Creative Intelligence Suite (CIS)	Innovation, brainstorming, design thinking

Creative Intelligence Suite

version v0.1.9 License MIT Discord Join Community

Think differently. A collection of agents and workflows for innovation, brainstorming, design thinking, and creative problem-solving.

About CIS

The Creative Intelligence Suite (CIS) extends BMad Method with tools for the fuzzy front-end of development—where ideas are born, problems are reframed, and solutions emerge through structured creativity.

Modules Included

Agent/Workflow	Purpose
Innovation Strategist	Identify disruption opportunities and business model innovation
Design Thinking Coach	Human-centered design through empathy, ideation, and prototyping
Brainstorming Coach	Facilitate creative ideation sessions with proven techniques
Problem Solver	Systematic problem diagnosis and root cause analysis
Creative Problem Solver	Generate creative solutions using lateral thinking
Storyteller	Craft compelling narratives for products and features
Presentation Master	Structure and deliver persuasive presentations

Installation

CIS is installed as a module during BMad Method setup:

```
npx bmad-method@alpha install
```

Select **Creative Intelligence Suite** from the modules list.

Quick Start

After installing BMad Method with CIS, try these workflows:

```
/cis-brainstorm      # Generate ideas with structured techniques
/cis-design-thinking # Human-centered design process
/cis-problem-solve   # Systematic problem analysis
/cis-innovation      # Business model and disruption analysis
```

We've been building our production prototype, entirely within the BMAD Framework - and I've been using the entirety of the Stanford Design Thinking process to drive the observations and feedback mechanisms that are the core of "Project Green".

There is a good chance that we are possibly two of the most over prepared founders on the planet, and we are moving fast, because it is our core belief that if we do not launch this year, or maybe even in the next two months, we will miss our window.

We are fully committed to achieving our objectives. We are using Discord as our primary team communication method - which does it make it a little "chaotic" because our advisory board is viewing our (my) stream of conciousness and collaborating in real time.

From our "Project Green Notes" channel in Discord;

Mike 9/12/2025 8:56 AM

What we are today 9/12/2025: A pre-incorporation single-member sole proprietorship with one contract/revenue share 12.5% FTE development partner and one single member sole proprietor acting as CEO and board chairman. The purpose of the organization is to develop a startup in search of a business model that provides services to small and medium high profit accounting firms.

What we are today updated 2/28/2026: A pre-incorporation single-member sole proprietorship with one contract/revenue share 12.5% FTE development partner and one single member sole proprietor acting as CEO and board chairman. The purpose of the organization is to develop a startup in search of a business model that provides services to small and medium high profit accounting firms. Our latest milestone achieved is we have agreed to deliver our prototype to our alpha test customer! There are six potential advisory board members that have been offered an advisory board seat, some of them have not yet committed but the offer is still open. Today I am extending that offer to a seventh. Each advisory board member, when confirmed, will receive 0.25% of revenue quarterly per the terms agreement, until formal entity creation, when those terms will be renegotiated. My intention is to convert revenue to equity and keep the 0.25% the same. Vision of what we might be become in the future: An organization that delivers a data secure, HIPPA and NIST compliant, digitial twin and LLM model to accounting firms that enables firm owners to query a natural language processor about any part of their accounting firm, and also enables any member of an accounting firm to query that same natural language processor about role specific information. I also envision a world where those same firm owners have the opton of licensing this technology to their client list, thus multiplying the potential target available market by about 90. This needs an update. Owen has 25% for being here since this was on a napkin.

-------- Our mid-term mission: Develop a service that accounting firms want and are willing to pay for. Our near-term mission: Develop a service that we can alpha test with a few accounting firms. --------

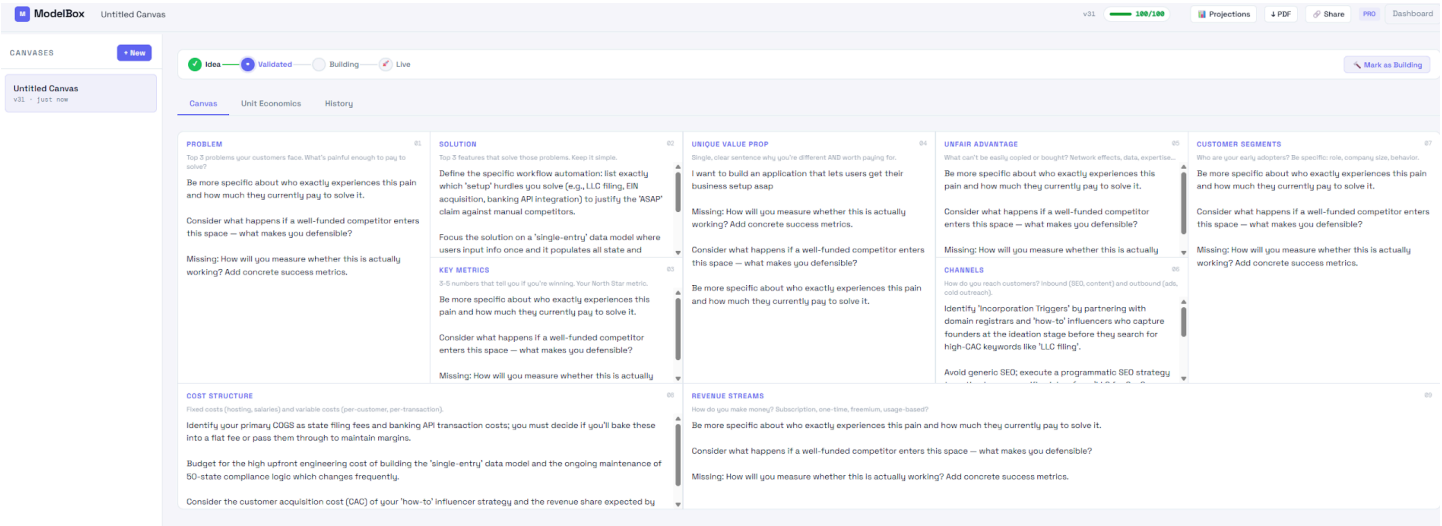
Initial Research Projects: These projects are designed for us to set up our development environment, gain experience working together, explore what is possible with local language models, test capabilities and potential solutions, discover challenges and potential solutions Project 1 - Develop and deploy three local LLMs (Owen PC - Mike Dev Box, Mike Daily Driver) - Initial Steps Complete - Downloaded Docker and run a local LLM from local PCs. Owen will work on attaching memory capabilities to the chat - and has the space to explore what features we are capable of

utilizing. Some initial use cases we can use to tinker with LLMs are writing a book, reviewing a resume, creating a virtual life assistant. Identified RAG method of memory - Owen continuing to explore and test memory and capabilities. We are continiing to explore context and will also explore how cursor can be used for rapid prototyping and development Project 2 - Develop and deploy a cloud shared LLM - talked a little bit about what this might look look like on 9/13/2025 - postponing this one for now while we further explore the capabilities of local LLMs and investigate the possibility of training a local LLM - project #3 Project 3 - Explore how to train those LLMs on a database of accounting information Project 4 - Explore how to live link changing information to the LLM, information from a cloud accounting ledger ---------

Our proposed future projects that support our current mission and our vision of what we might become in the future: Proposed Project: Customer Discovery Planning - researching potential customers, making first contact, having an offer that would entice them to become alpha users Proposed Project: Minimum Viable Product Development - Develop a HIPAA compliant or HIPAA+ compliant local llm that we have a method of training with loaded data, can link to an external API, has memory, and can link to various types of LLM readable database (conservation blocks, data tables), and can answer a series of selected prompts that hint at our future vision

I think at this point, the challenge is perhaps, catching you up in a timely manner.

Also - as a side project consulting lead gen mechanism - I produced this website as a 5 day side project: https://usemodelbox.ai/



In fact, the only thing not working well on this site at the moment is the google authentication for login, but if you sign up an email, and use the coupon code "DEVFEEDBACK", the product opens up and is free forever.

The offer is open, if you think it prudent to join our company discord as a mentor.

Addtitionally, over the past two months as our go to market strategy, I've been connecting into a network of other serial entrepreneurs and founders and sharing our journey, which we've been using to spark innovation in our peer group, and feeds back into what we are doing with Project Green.

I think the key part in my discord notes is how I described the project on day one our founding when Owen and I setup the company discord - "The purpose of this organization is to develop a startup in search of a business model."

Our documentation folder in our development repository:

Name	Date modified	Type	Size
project-structure-dependency-graph.md	3/16/2026 4:41 PM	MD File	20 KB
epic-34-user-product-testing.md	3/16/2026 7:02 AM	MD File	5 KB
product-roadmap-future.md	3/15/2026 6:35 AM	MD File	14 KB
roadmap-forward.md	3/15/2026 6:12 AM	MD File	39 KB
test-strategy.md	3/14/2026 5:20 PM	MD File	5 KB
architecture.md	3/14/2026 4:37 PM	MD File	27 KB
project-overview.md	3/13/2026 10:37 AM	MD File	6 KB
index.md	3/13/2026 10:37 AM	MD File	5 KB
dev-tools.png	3/13/2026 10:33 AM	PNG File	564 KB
dev-tools-analysis.md	3/13/2026 10:33 AM	MD File	60 KB
PRD.md	3/12/2026 1:03 PM	MD File	39 KB
PRD-validation-report.md	3/12/2026 5:28 AM	MD File	16 KB
sprint-client-id-scope.md	3/11/2026 7:57 PM	MD File	4 KB
customer-onboarding.md	3/11/2026 1:23 AM	MD File	4 KB
deployment-guide.md	3/11/2026 1:21 AM	MD File	6 KB
current-state.md	3/6/2026 10:45 AM	MD File	10 KB
owner-one-pager.md	3/6/2026 10:44 AM	MD File	4 KB
production-rebuild-blueprint.md	3/6/2026 10:44 AM	MD File	37 KB
development-guide.md	3/6/2026 10:44 AM	MD File	8 KB
phase-1-sprint-plan.md	3/6/2026 10:37 AM	MD File	12 KB
product-direction.md	3/6/2026 10:36 AM	MD File	6 KB
architectural-decisions.md	3/6/2026 10:36 AM	MD File	12 KB
project-context.md	3/6/2026 10:35 AM	MD File	22 KB
roadmap.md	3/6/2026 10:25 AM	MD File	18 KB
api-contracts.md	3/5/2026 2:09 PM	MD File	8 KB
data-models.md	3/5/2026 2:09 PM	MD File	15 KB
dev-notes.md	3/4/2026 1:19 PM	MD File	4 KB
Legal Agreements	3/17/2026 6:41 PM	File folder	
strategy	3/16/2026 10:37 PM	File folder	
testing	3/16/2026 12:04 PM	File folder	
Assistance Screenshots	3/16/2026 11:09 AM	File folder	
stories	3/16/2026 7:05 AM	File folder	
security	3/15/2026 5:48 AM	File folder	
research	3/13/2026 10:37 AM	File folder	
archive	3/13/2026 10:34 AM	File folder	
sprint-changes	3/13/2026 10:34 AM	File folder	
debug	3/13/2026 10:33 AM	File folder	
product-development	3/6/2026 10:44 AM	File folder	
ideas	3/4/2026 9:46 AM	File folder	
knowledge	3/4/2026 9:45 AM	File folder	
runbook	3/2/2026 6:57 AM	File folder	

Our Strategy Folder;

Name	Date modified	Type	Size
business-plan	3/4/2026 5:43 PM	File folder	
fundraising	3/6/2026 10:38 AM	File folder	
ai-readiness-assessment.md	3/3/2026 5:47 AM	MD File	15 KB
alpha-customer-agreement.md	3/3/2026 5:47 AM	MD File	5 KB
business-model-dual-license.md	3/16/2026 10:32 PM	MD File	6 KB
demo-playbook.md	3/6/2026 10:37 AM	MD File	14 KB
executive-strategy-brief.md	3/6/2026 10:44 AM	MD File	9 KB
financial-framework.md	3/3/2026 5:47 AM	MD File	9 KB
go-to-market.md	3/6/2026 10:25 AM	MD File	13 KB
gtm-evaluation.md	3/6/2026 10:37 AM	MD File	13 KB
lead-gen-target-lists.md	3/3/2026 5:47 AM	MD File	28 KB
market-gap-analysis.md	3/3/2026 5:47 AM	MD File	22 KB
market-landscape.md	3/3/2026 5:47 AM	MD File	10 KB
market-research-gaps.md	3/3/2026 5:47 AM	MD File	22 KB
product-strategy.md	3/3/2026 5:47 AM	MD File	10 KB
prospect-briefing-andrew.md	3/6/2026 10:37 AM	MD File	15 KB
README.md	3/3/2026 5:47 AM	MD File	3 KB
risk-register.md	3/6/2026 10:18 AM	MD File	23 KB
technical-architecture.md	3/3/2026 5:47 AM	MD File	14 KB
traction-acceleration.md	3/6/2026 10:37 AM	MD File	20 KB
vision-roadmap.md	3/16/2026 10:37 PM	MD File	17 KB

Our business planning folder:

Name	Date modified	Type	Size
01-problem-opportunity-why-now.md	3/3/2026 5:47 AM	MD File	9 KB
02-solution-and-product.md	3/3/2026 11:15 PM	MD File	11 KB
03-market-and-competition.md	3/3/2026 5:47 AM	MD File	12 KB
04-business-model-and-gtm.md	3/3/2026 5:47 AM	MD File	13 KB
05-financials.md	3/3/2026 11:12 PM	MD File	12 KB
06-traction-team-ask-risks.md	3/5/2026 6:02 PM	MD File	13 KB
business_plan_state.md	3/3/2026 11:15 PM	MD File	8 KB
business-plan.md	3/4/2026 5:40 PM	MD File	68 KB
business-plan.pdf	3/4/2026 4:56 PM	Adobe Acrobat Docu...	548 KB
Project-Green-Business-Plan.pdf	3/4/2026 5:42 PM	Adobe Acrobat Docu...	628 KB
Project-Green-Business-Plan.zip	3/4/2026 4:58 PM	Compressed (zipped)...	178 KB
README.md	3/3/2026 5:47 AM	MD File	3 KB

Name	Date modified	Type	Size
demo-script.md	3/3/2026 11:15 PM	MD File	8 KB
executive-summary.md	3/3/2026 11:14 PM	MD File	6 KB
financial-model.md	3/3/2026 11:12 PM	MD File	14 KB
fundraising-strategy.md	3/6/2026 10:38 AM	MD File	17 KB
investor-memo.md	3/3/2026 11:14 PM	MD File	20 KB
investor-targets.md	3/3/2026 11:14 PM	MD File	13 KB
legal-prerequisites.md	3/6/2026 10:19 AM	MD File	12 KB
one-pager.md	3/3/2026 11:14 PM	MD File	3 KB
pitch-deck-content.md	3/3/2026 11:15 PM	MD File	22 KB
README.md	3/6/2026 10:37 AM	MD File	4 KB

We moving into customer development now - I've been holding off the past two weeks while my W2 job figures out what they want to do, I pitched to this at a high level (it wasn't a great pitch, I didn't show a demo, I didn't provide a business plan). They've now turned me down explicitly three times on this idea, once at inception, once after my February performance review, and again in an explicit pitch moment.. Which, as I mentioned, I've retained a California startup attorney to guide me through that process to ensure they do not have a legal claim for our invention. I believe am covered on that topic.

This is a sensitive time in our startup history, I am preparing to leave a W2 position, and the conversation is now about transition, and/or future employment, because they **could** be interested in becoming our first customer, in that I we would get an ironclad Non-Disclosure and set of complete legal agreements regarding the rights of project Green, and then they become Project Green's first customer - they are an accounting firm in LA providing entertainment "business management", which is to say an accounting firm specializing in the entertainment business and high net wealth family office services.

I know this is alot, but based on your profile and experience, I believe you may consume this information, and then want more.

I am ready for that.

Best,

Mike
ML Financial Group
Mobile: 772-713-0935

[Quoted text hidden]

ML Financial Group <mike@mlgroup.us> Thu, Mar 19, 2026 at 4:26 AM
To: Naeem Malik <naeem.malik@scorevolunteer.org>
Cc: Owen Peterson <ocpeterson@yahoo.com>

Sir, your canvas is thoughtfully prepared, I will complete this canvas and circle back.

Best,

Mike
ML Financial Group
Mobile: 772-713-0935

[Quoted text hidden]